Unit 3 — Science and Ethics

Track E · Klasse 12 · Niveau E (Basisfach / Leistungsfach)

Niveau E

1. Vocabulary

Match each item to its meaning or use it in a sentence.

Term	Your note
precautionary principle	
dual-use research	
informed consent	
moratorium	
governance	
irreversibility	
externality	
stakeholder engagement	
transparency	
peer review	
replication	
bioethics committee	

2. Reading

Read the text, then answer in full sentences.

Consequentialism asks what produces the best outcomes? — including risks, who bears them, and across what time horizon. Deontology asks what are we required to do regardless of consequences? — informed consent, dignity, irreversible-harm thresholds. Virtue ethics asks what kind of researcher / institution do we want to be?. Real-world ethics-of-science debates almost always combine all three; pretending the debate is purely consequentialist is itself a philosophical position.

3. Practise

1. Match: precautionary principle → caution under uncertainty; dual use → research with both civilian and military potential; moratorium → temporary halt.
2. T or F: consequentialism rules out informed consent; deontology rules out cost-benefit thinking.
3. Build 4 sentences applying consequentialist + deontological + virtue-ethics moves to the CRISPR case.

4. Write

Science-ethics essay, 350 words. Pick one case (CRISPR / LLMs / climate intervention). Build a structured argument with one consequentialist move + one deontological move + one virtue-ethics move + one disagreement / acknowledgement. Use 4 academic discourse markers + 1 cleft.

Lösungen **Controlled.** 1. all true.
2. F (consequentialism includes consent under expected-value), F (deontology accepts cost-benefit as a secondary tool, not primary).
Productive. 3. Open.